

COMMUNITY MESSAGE PLATFORM

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INTRODUCTION

The Community Message Platform is a website designed to support structured and efficient communication within residential communities. Traditional communication methods, such as noticeboards and passing messages by word of mouth, are often outdated and unable to deliver important information in a timely way. Built with Laravel Livewire (frontend) and Node.js (backend), the app features:

Visitor Track Location with graphical visualizations.

Emergency Alert for immediate assistance.

Multiculture Festival and History Sharing.

Messaging system for community.

Community service to understand who is serving in the community.

Facilities for booking that have provide in the community.

Event that can allow users to create their own event and join event.

Community Forum for giving everyone in community can sharing their daily life related to the community.

This manual provides step-by-step instructions to set up and run the application as user.

REQUIRED FILES

To run the application, ensure the following tools are installed on your system:

Prerequisites

1. **PHP 8.2+** (via XAMPP is easiest)
 - Download: <https://www.php.net/downloads>
 - Required for running Laravel and run my app locally.
2. **Composer**
 - Composer is used to install packages like Livewire.
 - Download: <https://getcomposer.org/download/>
3. **Node.js 18+**
 - Download: <https://nodejs.org/>
 - Can use for used frontend tools like: Tailwind CSS and Vite.
4. **XAMPP**
 - **Install from the Window or IOS:** <https://www.apachefriends.org/>.
 - Used to connect and open the MySQL for storing data.

Dependencies

After installing the prerequisite, install the following dependencies:

1. Navigate to the Project Folder and run "cd dg_fyp\FYP\community-app"
2. Install PHP Dependencies "composer install"
3. Install Node and run "npm install"

COMMANDS TO RUN

This section provides a detailed, step-by-step guide on executing the PHP program within a Laravel environment. We will walk you through the necessary instructions and commands to successfully run the application.

Step 1: Navigate to the file location

Navigate to the file location by entering "C:\Projects\community-app\"

Step 2: Run command to the file for doing installation

Enter "composer install"

Step 3: Run command to the file for Install Frontend Packages

Enter "npm install"

Step 4: change the Environment File

Open ".env" and regenerate the app key "php artisan key:generate"

DB_CONNECTION=mysql

DB_HOST=127.0.0.1

DB_PORT=3306

DB_DATABASE=laravel_fyp

DB_USERNAME=root

DB_PASSWORD=

Step 5: Create the MySQL Database

1. Open XAMPP Control Panel → Start **Apache** and **MySQL**.
2. Open your browser → go to <http://localhost/phpmyadmin>.
3. Click **New** in the left sidebar.
4. Database name: laravel_fyp
5. Collation: utf8mb4_unicode_ci

6. Click **Create**.

Step 6: Run Database Migrations

Enter “php artisan migrate”

If asked "Do you want to run migrations?" → type yes and press Enter.

Step 7 — Create Storage Link

Enter “php artisan storage:link” for allows uploaded files

Step 8 — Run the Application

Open 3 separate PowerShell

Terminal 1 — Laravel Web Server

Enter “php artisan serve”

Terminal 2 — Vite Frontend (CSS + JS Hot Reload)

Enter “npm run dev”

Terminal 3 — Laravel Reverb (WebSockets / Live Chat)

Enter “php artisan reverb:start”

Step 9 — Open the App

Open with <http://localhost:8000>

Other Information for open admin

Creating an Admin Account

1. Go to <http://localhost/phpmyadmin> → laravel_fyp → users table.
2. Find your user row → click Edit.
3. Set the user type column to admin.
4. Click Save.

Enter “php artisan tinker” and “\App\Models\User::where('email', 'your@email.com')->update(['user_type' => 'admin']);”

exit”

Final Check List for all the installation

- [1] PHP 8.2+ installed
- [2] Composer installed
- [3] Node.js 18+ & npm installed
- [4] MySQL running (XAMPP)
- [5] composer install
- [6] npm install
- [7] .env file configured with correct DB credentials
- [8] Database 'laravel_fyp' created in MySQL
- [9] php artisan migrate
- [10] php artisan storage:link
- [] Terminal 1: php artisan serve
- [] Terminal 2: npm run dev
- [] Terminal 3: php artisan reverb:start
- [11] Open <http://localhost:8000> in browser

CONCLUSION

This manual provides clear instructions to run the Community Message Platform, a platform's overall goals are to enhance communication, boost participation, and build a more cohesive community. By following these steps, users can successfully launch the app for development or testing purposes.